

CUSTOMISE YOUR ANDROID DEVICE

Unlocking a boot loader and flashing custom ROMs take your default Android experience to an entirely different level, permitting you to install custom mods or ROMs that can change the way you look at your Android phone.

However, with flashing custom ROMs, you surrender the security, simplicity and



Make the lock screen informative

reliability of your Android device. Wouldn't it be great if rooting gave you all those features that are accessible only through custom ROMs?

Helping you do just that is 'Xposed', a framework that can change the behavior of the system and apps without touching any APKs.

While you can visit <http://dgigit.in/XposedFr> to know more about this framework, we'll briefly cover this interesting Xposed module at the end of these tips and tricks.

Note: Some of the tips mentioned here strictly require a rooted Android phone. However, we've clearly mentioned which tips require a rooted Android. In case you don't know how to root an Android



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{ Tips & Tricks has its own page numbers, and does not follow the rest of the magazine's page numbers. This is done to ensure that you can cut out and save T&T in a separate folder for later reference. }

phone, learn how to do it at <http://dgigit.in/XDARoot>

Making the lock screen more informative

On the off chance that you lose your Android phone, it's quite unlikely that you'll get it back, but just on the off-chance that you might, here are a few tips.

While an easy-to-use tool such as Android Device Manager (<http://dgigit.in/ADMGoogle>) can be of assistance, there's no guarantee that your device will be found. Regardless of the low possibility that someone will return it, password protecting your device will at least ensure that if a good Samaritan gets hold of your phone, they'll have a way of returning it.

With Android Jelly Bean, you can show your contact information on the lock screen of your phone. Go to Settings > Security > Screen security > Owner info. Here, you can enter your name, email address, contact number or any other detail you want to display on the lock screen.

Creating custom icons

Websites such as Android Asset Studio (<http://dgigit.in/GithubAAS>) and Android Icon Generator (<http://dgigit.in/IconGAAS>) let you produce icons from any picture you wish to add. Simply upload an image from your PC and choose from the given options to resize and crop it. Now save the file on your PC. Next, connect your Android



Icon Changer Free

device to your PC and move your icons into your phone's Pictures folder. This will make the icons visible in the gallery. You can then use a free application like Icon Changer Free (<http://dgigit.in/IconChangerFree>) or Folder Organizer lite (<http://dgigit.in/FolderOrganizerlite>) to make easy shortcuts with your own custom icons.

Control your notifications

A barrage of notifications on our Android phones can sometimes be enough to drive us up a wall. If you want to disable these constant notifications, open the 'Settings' menu and go to 'Apps'. Find the application that inundates you with the most notifications and tap its name to expand the related options. Close to the top, just beneath the 'Force Stop' button, uncheck the 'Show notifications' checkbox to make the notifications stop appearing. This technique strictly works on devices running Android 4.1 or higher.

Setting quick responses

Ever received a call on your phone when you were watching a movie in a theater? At times



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